

“Open source has enabled us to add the desired value to our products”

Open source software has touched many lives (read, companies). Products and technologies based on open source are known to be successful, which is why a company like Unisys Corporation is banking on it for the bandwidth it gives firms to experiment and innovate. Unisys does a major part of its development work in India, as it finds the open source talent pool here one of the best in the world. **Diksha P Gupta** from *Open Source For You* spoke to **Jim Thompson, CTO, TCIS, Unisys** and **L N V Samy, VP, Engineering, GTC, Unisys**, about the firm's operations in India. Excerpts:



Jim Thompson, CTO, TCIS, Unisys

Q Tell us more about Unisys' establishment in India?

A We have a large investment in the engineering facility in Bengaluru. Looking at the Indian market from a global perspective, what we are trying to do is address the changing landscape on the data side and introduce a hybrid cloud environment. We all know about the public clouds like the Amazons and the Rackspace of the world, but enterprises are now trying to get into a hybrid-cloud kind of scenario. So, a lot of our technology is related to enabling that and ensuring our clients make the best use of what they want to keep within their enterprises, even while being able to take things to the public environment like Amazon Web Services, Google and other such options.

Unisys India is responsible for a fair amount of such work. It is extremely important for us to be here—to be in touch and in sync with all of this. We have got a fairly aggressive product development schedule. Our product, which caters a lot to the hybrid cloud space, is being developed in India.

Q It is a known fact that India has a lot of talented engineers. Apart from the talent that you get here, are there any other attractions India has?

A We have been in Bengaluru for ten years now. We came to India for the same reasons that most companies do. One of the major reasons for so much of our development work being concentrated within the country is the talent that is available to us. In India, there is a higher graduation rate among software engineers as well as among engineers from various other branches. So there is no dearth of skills in the labour pool. And being a global company, we invest on a global basis. So, India is a natural place for us to come and do business. With respect to the workforce, we enjoy good retention rates. We get very talented people and they are doing good work. So it's a win-win for all of us.

Q Could you throw some light on the kind of development work that is happening in the Indian facility?

A We do a wide variety of development work. We take care of a set of our core business products, which are responsible for a big chunk of our revenue. We are also doing new development work here in Bengaluru. We discovered that the best thing we could do would be one full lifecycle of a project here, in India. So a lot of work is being done here on our hybrid cloud offering. A lot of our security work around our products is also being done here. A couple of big projects in terms of our forward-looking investments are being handled here, along with a lot of test activities linked to our projects.

Q Do you do development work around open source technology in India?

A Absolutely. I think what any serious development organisation does today is a mix of applied research using